

Friday, 9 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

18° 11°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

16° 10°

MANCHESTER

Rain

16° 10°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

14° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- The UK Prime Minister, Hannah Burnham, is heading to Berlin today for security talks with the German Chancellor.**

Downing Street says that strengthening co-operation against growing 'hybrid threats' from Russia will be a key topic. This marks Burnham's first official visit to Germany since taking office.

POLITICS · UK

- Eleven people have been arrested in London following a series of pro-Palestinian marches across the capital.**

The Metropolitan Police confirmed five arrests were made outside the Board of Deputies of British Jews office, on suspicion of inciting racial hatred. Other arrests were for various public order offences.

PROTEST · UK

- Royal Mail has announced plans to cut around 2,500 jobs by the end of 2027.**

The postal service firm intends to reduce roles primarily within its head office and other non-frontline departments. This comes as the company continues to restructure its operations.

BUSINESS · UK

- A man has been jailed for killing his ex-partner just days after being released from prison.**

Robert Sabat received a minimum 17-year jail term for the fatal stabbing of his former partner. The case has raised questions about early release protocols.

CRIME · UK

- In a significant legal development, former bankers jailed for rigging interest rates have had their convictions overturned.**

The Court of Appeal quashed the convictions of Jay Merchant, Jonathan Mathew, Philippe Moryoussef, Alex Pabon, and Colin Bermingham. They were previously found guilty of manipulating Libor rates.

FINANCE · UK

What's coming up

1 **Great news for fans of 'Gavin and Stacey' – creators Ruth Jones and James Corden have revealed the star-studded cast for their new show!**

Joining them will be big names like James McAvoy from 'X-Men' and the legendary Jim Broadbent. It sounds like a must-watch for comedy fans.

ON AIR – What kind of show do you think it will be? Will it capture that 'Gavin and Stacey' magic?

TV · COMING SOON

2 **Gaming giant Xbox is making a big bet on its flagship title 'Gears of War' in the ongoing battle with rival consoles.**

The new game, 'E-Day', will be exclusively available on Xbox, a strategic move at a time when console costs are on the rise. It's a bold play to entice gamers.

ON AIR – Are console exclusives a good thing for gamers, or do they just limit choice?

GAMING · NEW RELEASE

3 **Stephen King's horror classic 'Carrie' is set for a modern-day return, exploring the terrifying impact of social media.**

This new adaptation promises to bring the story's themes of bullying and isolation into the digital age. The creators believe it's a timely re-imagining.

ON AIR – Do classic horror stories need modern updates, or should some things be left untouched?

FILM · COMING SOON

4 **Beloved Winnie-the-Pooh books are set to fill phone box libraries across the country!**

The original publisher is donating A.A. Milne's classics, along with a brand new authorised sequel, to these community book-swapping hubs. It's a lovely way to share stories.

ON AIR – What's your favourite childhood book you'd love to see in a phone box library?

BOOKS · COMMUNITY

5 **Video game fans, get ready for what's being called the 'biggest puzzle game ever' from 'Braid' creator Jonathan Blow!**

'Order of the Sinking Star' is due out today, boasting an astonishing 1,500 puzzles for players to tackle. It promises a truly epic challenge.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of puzzle games, or do you prefer something with more action?

GAMING · NEW RELEASE

On the schedule

- 1 Mikel Arteta has signed a new contract with Premier League champions Arsenal, keeping him at the club until 2030.**

Arteta declared this is "only the beginning" of Arsenal's success, following their title win. It's a clear statement of intent from the club.

ON AIR – Do you think Arteta can build a lasting dynasty at Arsenal, or is the Premier League too competitive?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Great news for Arsenal fans, as Declan Rice is reportedly close to agreeing a new long-term deal with the club.**

Sources close to the club indicate that an agreement is imminent. This would be a huge boost for the Gunners, securing one of their key players for the foreseeable future.

ON AIR – How important is it for clubs to tie down their top talent like Declan Rice?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 England captain Harry Kane is targeting an incredible 100 international goals after equalling his country's appearance record.**

Kane, who now has 125 caps, received praise from teammates Morgan Rogers and Jude Bellingham. It would be an astonishing achievement for the striker.

ON AIR – Could Harry Kane actually reach 100 goals for England? What an achievement that would be!

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Southampton manager Tonda Eckert is free to continue in his role after receiving a suspended ban for his part in 'Spygate'.**

The decision means Eckert can remain on the touchline for the Saints. It brings some clarity to the situation following the recent controversy.

ON AIR – Do you think a suspended ban is a fair outcome for the 'Spygate' incident?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Britain's George Russell will start from the back of the grid in Sunday's Singapore Grand Prix.**

This is due to a power-unit penalty incurred from last weekend's race. It means he'll have a tough challenge ahead to climb through the field.

ON AIR – How much will this grid penalty affect George Russell's chances in Singapore?

FORMULA 1 · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new appreciation is blossoming for the delightful charm of 'heritage vegetable patches' in allotments and gardens across the UK.**
Gardeners are finding joy in cultivating forgotten varieties of carrots, tomatoes, and beans, celebrating their unique flavours and historical significance. It's a lovely way to connect with the past and enjoy some truly distinctive produce.
- 2 Experts are highlighting the surprisingly calming effect of 'watching bread rise'.**
The slow, transformative process of dough expanding in a warm kitchen is proving to be a meditative experience for home bakers. It's a wonderful, gentle reminder of simple pleasures.
- 3 The delightful trend of 'afternoon tea adventures' is gaining popularity, with friends exploring charming tea rooms in different towns.**
It's all about discovering quaint spots, sampling unique scone recipes, and enjoying civilised conversation away from the everyday hustle and bustle. A perfectly British pastime!
- 4 Research suggests that 'mindful window gazing' can be a genuine mood booster.**
Taking a moment to simply observe the world outside, whether it's the changing weather or a neighbour tending their garden, can offer a surprisingly peaceful escape. It's a free and easy way to find a moment of calm.
- 5 There's a quiet resurgence in the art of 'handwritten thank you notes', with many finding them more meaningful than digital messages.**
The personal touch of a thoughtfully penned card is being rediscovered as a sincere way to express gratitude. It truly makes someone's day to receive one through the post.
- 6 A study reveals the unexpected satisfaction found in 'perfectly peeling a piece of fruit'.**
Whether it's an orange in one long strip or a banana without a single stringy bit, the small victory of a clean peel brings a surprising sense of accomplishment. Who knew fruit could be so rewarding?
- 7 The gentle pastime of 'cloud gazing' is being championed as a simple way to spark creativity and relax the mind.**
Lying back and finding shapes in the clouds encourages imaginative thought and offers a lovely break from screen time. It's a timeless activity that's free for everyone to enjoy.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new box of chocolates, especially if it's a fancy selection. What is it?

ANSWER: LOOKING AT THE FLAVOUR GUIDE AND CAREFULLY PLANNING WHICH ORDER THEY'LL EAT THEM IN, USUALLY SAVING THE BEST UNTIL LAST!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY TAPPING THE PACKET TO SEE IF THEY SOUND 'FIRM' OR 'CRUMBLY' – AN ESSENTIAL BISCUIT-BUYING RITUAL!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't seen one in years?

What's that one biscuit that takes you right back, and what's the memory attached to it? Give us a call!

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's a simple, kind gesture you've either given or received recently that really brightened things up? Let us know!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space junk' problem, and scientists have created a special 'space harpoon' to try and clean up some of the debris orbiting Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts often carry a small, perfectly preserved Victorian teddy bear with them into space for good luck and to act as a zero-gravity indicator.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The tiny country of San Marino is the oldest surviving republic in the world, founded in 301 AD.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', which seems rather fitting for such wise-looking birds.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic Pringle cans.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress signal.
- Finland has more saunas than cars, with an estimated two million saunas for its 5.5 million people.
- The 'richest' soil in the world is found in the Amazon rainforest, supporting incredible biodiversity.
- The unique scent of rain after a dry spell is called petrichor.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.

On this day

Day 282 of the year, 83 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham; Christian feast day: Denis of Paris; Christian feast day: Dionysius the Areopagite; Christian feast day: Ghislain. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — PJ Harvey, English musician, singer-songwriter, writer, poet, and composer
- 1971 — Sian Evans, Welsh singer
- 1976 — Lee Peacock, Scottish footballer and coach
- 1978 — Nicky Byrne, Irish singer-songwriter
- 1944 — Nona Hendryx, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1976 — Nick Swardson, American actor and comedian
- 1949 — Rod Temperton, English keyboard player, songwriter, and producer (died 2016)
- 1979 — Alex Greenwald, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — South Korean President Chun Doo-hwan survives an assassination attempt in Rangoon, Burma, but the blast kills 21 and injures 17 others.
- 1981 — President François Mitterrand abolishes capital punishment in France.
- 1967 — A day after his capture, Ernesto "Che" Guevara is executed for attempting to incite a revolution in Bolivia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1986 — The Phantom of the Opera, eventually the second longest running musical in London, opens at Her Majesty's Theatre.
- 1966 — Vietnam War: the Republic of Korea Army commits the Binh Tai Massacre.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Hurricane Milton makes landfall in Siesta Key, Florida, as a Category 3 hurricane, causing US\$34.3 billion in damage only two weeks after Hurricane Helene impacted the state.
- 1963 — In Italy, a large landslide causes a giant wave to overtop the Vajont Dam, killing over 2,000.

- 1969 — In Chicago, the National Guard is called in as demonstrations continue over the trial of the "Chicago Eight".

A peek at tomorrow

Day 283 of the year, 82 days left in 2026. Today Aleksis Kivi Day, also known as the Finnish Literature Day (Finland); Arbor Day (Poland); Army Day (Sri Lanka); Capital Liberation Day (Vietnam). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Jessica Harper, American actress
- 1982 — Dan Stevens, English actor
- 1946 — Ben Vereen, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1989 — Emer Kenny, English actress and screenwriter
- 1948 — Cyril Neville, American R&B percussionist and singer
- 1970 — Matthew Pinsent, English rower and sportscaster
- 1941 — Peter Coyote, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Julia Sweeney, American actress, comedian, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1980 — The 7.1 Mw El Asnam earthquake shakes northern Algeria, killing 2,633 and injuring 8,369.
- 1973 — U.S. Vice President Spiro Agnew resigns after being charged with evasion of federal income tax.
- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1980 — The Farabundo Martí National Liberation Front is founded in El Salvador.
- 1964 — The Tokyo Summer Olympics opening ceremony is the first to be relayed live by satellites.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar